Goal0: Deliver a Profitable and Sustainable MMORPG Experience
part of
Goal1: Achieve a Large and Loyal Paying Player Base
part of
Goal2: Achieve Strong and Sustainable Revenue
part of
Goal3: Achieve Rich Community and Creator Contributions
part of
Goal4: Achieve Efficient and Reliable Live-Service Operations
part of
Goal5: Achieve Innovative and Responsible AI-Enhanced Gameplay
part of
G1.1 Increase Short-Session Participation
part of
G1.2 Increase Long-Session Participation
part of
G1.3 Increase Long-Term Player Retention
part of
G1.4 Acquire New Paying Players
part of
G2.1 Increase Recurring Subscription Revenue
part of
G2.2 Grow Marketplace and Partner Fee Income
part of
G2.3 Maintain Monetization Fairness
part of
G3.1 Increase Player Participation in Game Improvement
part of
G3.2 Increase Creator Participation in Content Creation
part of
G4.1 Control Cloud and LLM Operating Costs
part of
G4.2 Maintain Reliable, Low-Latency Service Quality
part of
G5.1 Increase Adoption of the AI Weapon-Spirit Companion
part of
G5.2 Increase Appeal of the Adaptive High-Difficulty Instance
part of
G5.3 Keep AI-Related Risks within Acceptable Limits
quantifies
O1:≥60% of active players complete one low-difficulty instance per week by month 6
quantifies
O2: ≥25% of active players join the weekend high-difficulty instance by month 6
quantifies
O3: Month-3 retention ≥40% by month 12
quantifies
O4: ≥170,000 active players by month 12
quantifies
O5: Subscription attach rate ≥30% by month 12
quantifies
O6: Marketplace sales and third-party service fees together ≥15% of total revenue by month 12
quantifies
quantifies
O7: 100% of paid items provide no combat-power advantage from launch
O8: Unauthorized RMT reports <0.5% of accounts per month by month 6
quantifies
O9: ≥10 Game Forum ideas adopted per quarter
quantifies
O10: ≥80 active creators with ≥100 approved items in Year 1; review within 7 business days, bounties paid within 48 hours
quantifies
O11: Cloud + LLM cost per monthly active player ≤20% of average revenue per player by month 12
quantifies
O12: ≥99.5% availability and <50ms regional latency from launch
quantifies
O13: ≥50% of monthly active players use the companion weekly by month 6
quantifies
O14: ≥40% of low-difficulty instance players join high-difficulty instance within 4 weeks by month 6
quantifies
quantifies
O15: AI companion replies flagged as inappropriate (by filters or player reports) <0.1% of all companion chats by month 6
O16: Wipes in which logged boss damage exceeds its preset limit <2% of monitored hign-difficulty instances during beta
supports
M1: Provide 15-minute low-difficutly-instance with instant matchmaking
supports
M2: Provide the weekend high-difficulty instance for 5–10 players
supports
M3: Let players craft and upgrade their own exclusive weapon in the Sanctuary Workshop to build long-term attachment
supports
M4: Launch on Steam (upfront purchase) with a wishlist campaign and Game Forum co-marketing
supports
M5: Offer convenience-only monthly subscription in 3 tiers, with flexible pause/resume passes
supports
M6: Operate an authorised marketplace for 3D models and third-party non-combat services (10% share)
M7: Gold usable only in Sanctum Exchange and workshop for material and weapon-blue print trade and upgrading or produce new weapons
supports
M8: Restrict subscription perks and certified marketplace to convenience/cosmetic items
supports
supports
M9: Operate the Game Forum as a structured feedback/idea channel with adoption bounties
supports
M10: Open, standardised submission pipeline with automated + manual QA review, plus an approval bounty for creators who pass
supports
M11: Cost governance: auto-scaling, LLM call quotas, replaceable lightweight LLM
supports
M12: Purchase low-latency network service from partner ISPs for all paying players
supports
M13: Provide the companion with bounded memory and real-time dialogue
supports
M14: Provide an adaptive high-difficulty instance boss using a validated ability pool
M15: Dialogue safeguards and human moderation for flagged content
supports
M16: Hard numerical damage/difficulty limits on the adaptive boss
supports
I1: Fast-session games compete for fragmented time
threat
threat
I2: Players can easily switch between competing games
threat
I3: Established MMORPGs have large player bases
I11: Dependence on Steam as the main distribution channel and revenue-share partner
threat
weakness
I12: Limited initial brand recognition and player community
opportunity
I4: Players are fatigued with pay-to-win designs
I5: Players increasingly expect meaningful interaction with game developers
opportunity
threat
I6: Dependence on external LLM/cloud vendors
threat
threat
I7: Dependence on ISP partners
threat
I8: New entrants can quickly copy the basic gameplay framework
threat
I9: Tightening AI / data-privacy regulation
strength
I10: In-house AI-driven gameplay design is a core differentiator
strength

Key Assumptions

- We assume that target players are adult (18+) PC co-op MMORPG players, mostly working adults, who have 6–10 hours of weekly gaming time, divided between short low-difficulty instances and longer high-difficulty instances.
- Following Porter's generic strategies, we pursue a differentiation focus: we serve this segment through AI-driven gameplay and a fair, non-pay-to-win economy, and we limit cost control to areas that do not differentiate the game.
- We assume that players value fair monetization and are willing to pay for cosmetic and convenience features, flexible subscription tiers and pause/resume passes rather than combat advantages.
- We assume that a 10% revenue share is sufficient to attract and retain authorised third-party suppliers, who sell non-combat customised services only.
- We assume that cloud and LLM API costs for the AI weapon-spirit companion remain manageable through Year 1 through auto-scaling and LLM call quotas that do not degrade differentiating AI features (keeping the target of ≥50% weekly companion use achievable), and that LLM vendors remain replaceable, while the adaptive boss of the high-difficulty instance is developed and operated in-house.
- We assume that Steam is the main distribution and promotion channel for the game, while our own marketplace website is the primary sales channel for virtual products.
- We assume that the company contracts partner ISPs directly for low-latency network service and provides it to all paying players at no extra charge.
- We assume that a 30% subscription attach rate on roughly 170,000 active players by month 12 yields about 50,000 paying subscribers.
- We define profitability as revenue covering operating costs (cloud, LLM, platform fees and creator buyouts) from month 18 after launch and sustained thereafter; development and staff costs are treated as fixed and outside the scope of this goal model.
- All numerical KPI targets are planning assumptions to be validated and recalibrated during beta, not committed final targets.

Strategy： We differentiate through fair monetization, offering cosmetic and convenience benefits without selling combat power.

Porter force	Influencers
Rivalry	I3
Buyer power	I2, I4, I5
Supplier power	I6, I7, I11
Threat of new entrants	I8
Threat of substitutes	I1

VDML role	Goal
Players	Goal1, Goal2
Steam	Goal1.4
Third-party suppliers	Goal2.2
3D creators	Goal3.2
Game Forum	Goal3.1
Cloud provider, LLM vendor	Goal4.1
Partner ISPs	Goal4.2